



JHUB AFRICA – INTERNSHIP ADMISSION & WORK PLAN

2025

VERSION 1



Table of Contents

1. Introduction.....	3
2. About JHUB Africa – Vision, Mission & Values.....	3
3. Document Purpose & Scope.....	3
4. Internship Objectives & Expected Learning Outcomes.....	4
5. Internship Categories.....	4
6. Required Application Documents.....	5
7. Internship Admission & Eligibility Criteria.....	5
8. Selection Process & Timeline.....	6
9. Placement Details.....	6
10. Working Hours & Attendance Policy.....	6
11. Onboarding & Orientation.....	7
12. Roles, Responsibilities & Expected Conduct.....	7
13. Work Plan & Sample Weekly Schedule.....	7
14. Productivity Metrics (KPIs).....	8
15. Reporting Requirements.....	9
16. Supervision, Mentorship, Professional Development & Log Book Submission Requirements.....	9
17. Performance Evaluation.....	10
18. Deliverables & Exit Requirements.....	10
19. Intellectual Property, Data Protection & Publication Policy.....	11
20. Benefits, Equipment & Logistics.....	11
21. Code of Conduct & Disciplinary Procedures.....	11
22. Termination, Extension & Grievance Procedures.....	11
23. Certification, References & Post-Internship Pathways.....	11
24. Governance & Contact Information.....	12
25. Appendices (Templates & Forms).....	12



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1. Introduction

JHUB Africa www.jhubafrica.com , is a **Digital Innovation Hub (DIH)** hosted at Jomo Kenyatta University of Agriculture and Technology (JKUAT), dedicated to fostering creative solutions, entrepreneurship, and impact-driven research. The Hub provides a collaborative space where students, researchers, industry leaders, and innovators converge to transform ideas into scalable startups and impactful realities, addressing Africa's pressing challenges in areas like AI, health, agriculture, climate, and governance.

This Internship Admission & Work Plan incorporates elements from the JHUB Africa Innovation Pathway to better align intern experiences with the hub's broader innovation ecosystem. It outlines terms for all interns, covering admission, roles, responsibilities, work plans, performance metrics, and governance. It applies to both the May–August Innovation Track and rolling Hub Operations Track placements, emphasizing structured pathways for skill development, mentorship, and post-internship support.

2. About JHUB Africa – Vision, Mission & Values

Vision: To be the leading catalyst for innovation in Africa, where ideas thrive, solutions scale, and lives are transformed.

Mission: To nurture innovation by providing a dynamic ecosystem bridging creativity and opportunity, fostering collaboration, and driving change.

Values:

- **Innovation:** Pioneering new ideas and bold solutions.
- **Collaboration:** Building communities through partnerships and shared purpose.
- **Integrity:** Upholding transparency and accountability.
- **Impact:** Driving meaningful, measurable change.

3. Document Purpose & Scope

- Formalises intern admission at JHUB Africa, aligning with the Innovation Pathway's structured intake process.
- Defines roles, responsibilities, deliverables, and measurable outcomes, integrating personalized learning paths and progress tracking.
- Provides templates for onboarding, reporting, log book submission and evaluation.



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- Sets out policies for confidentiality, intellectual property (IP), safety, conduct, and grievance resolution, drawing from the Pathway's IP and legal setup.

Scope: Applicable to all interns, whether lab-based or hub-based, with linkages to the Innovation Pathway for enhanced capability building.

4. Internship Objectives & Expected Learning Outcomes

Objectives:

- Provide hands-on experience in innovation processes, project delivery, and hub operations, aligned with the Innovation Pathway stages such as prototype development and market validation.
- Build technical, business, and soft skills relevant to entrepreneurship, including design thinking, lean startup methodology, and agile project management.
- Deliver tangible outputs advancing JHUB Africa projects or operations, contributing to the hub's ecosystem of idea transformation.

Expected Learning Outcomes:

- Contribution to at least one project deliverable (prototype, brief, communications asset, or operational improvement).
- Demonstrated growth in professional skills: project planning, communication, teamwork, and time management, supported by personalized learning paths.
- Completion of at least two blog posts and certifications from training/workshops during the internship.
- Personal development plan with measurable progress in 2–3 competency areas, informed by skills assessments.

5. Internship Categories

A. May–August (June - September) Innovation Track (Lab-Based):

- Work in groups on innovations at JHUB Africa, incorporating Pathway elements like prototype development and market validation.
- Monday–Thursday, 8:30 AM – 1:00 PM; 18 hours/week minimum.

B. Hub Operations Track (Rolling Intake, Hub-Based):

- Support innovation projects, communications, events, administration, with opportunities for peer-to-peer learning and mentorship.
- Monday–Friday, 8:00 AM – 5:00 PM; 40 hours/week minimum.



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6. Required Application Documents

1. Application Letter
2. Attachment/Recommendation Letter (stamped by institution)
3. Curriculum Vitae (CV)
4. Insurance Form from institution
5. Copy of National ID
6. Academic Transcripts
7. Motivation Statement (300–500 words) detailing:
 - Why you want to intern at JHUB Africa
 - Contributions you intend to bring, including alignment with priority areas (e.g., AI, health, agriculture)
 - How this internship aligns with your personal/professional goals and the Innovation Pathway
8. Supporting materials (optional): Pitch decks, prototypes, or demo links, as per the Pathway's application portal guidelines.

Incomplete submissions will not be considered.

7. Internship Admission & Eligibility Criteria

Eligibility:

- Alignment with JHUB Africa's mission, values, and priority areas (e.g., AI, health, agriculture, climate, governance).
- Commitment beyond course requirements.
- Relevant skills for assigned tasks, including potential for innovation and feasibility.
- Ability to work collaboratively in teams.

Selection Rubric (Refined with Pathway Scoring Matrix):

Criteria	Weight
Motivation & goal alignment (including Pathway alignment)	30%



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Skills & portfolio (novelty, feasibility, team strength)	25%
Interview & communication	20%
Pre-selection task (e.g., idea validation or prototype sketch)	15%
References & availability (societal impact, sustainability)	10%

Minimum qualifying score: 70/100

8. Selection Process & Timeline

1. Application submission via online form and physical submission of required documents
2. Administrative check
3. Pre-selection task (if required), such as a short pitch or prototype demo.
4. Interview with subject matter experts.
5. Scoring & selection using structured matrix; outcomes: Accepted or Rejected (with feedback and resources).
6. Offer & Placement Details form.
7. Onboarding & orientation.

9. Placement Details

- Intern Name, Category, Position, Department/Project
- Supervisor & Mentor names
- Start & End dates, weekly hours, location
- Key deliverables (3–5), tied to Pathway milestones (e.g., MVP development)
- Signatures: Intern, Supervisor, Program Lead

10. Working Hours & Attendance Policy

Innovation Track: Monday–Thursday, 8:30 AM – 1:00 PM

- Digital attendance logging; scoring:
 - o 8:00–8:40 AM = 1
 - o 8:41–9:00 AM = 0.75
 - o 9:01–9:30 AM = 0.5



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- o After 9:30 AM = absent

Hub Operations Track: Monday–Friday, 8:00 AM – 5:00 PM

- Weekly Google Sheet tracking outcomes mandatory, integrated with Pathway's performance analytics.

11. Onboarding & Orientation

- Pre-arrival: Equipment, accounts, schedule, onboarding pack; digital profile creation on JHUB portal for tracking milestones.
- Orientation Bootcamp: Introductions, tour, HR forms, safety briefing, systems setup, mentor matching; overview of Innovation Pathway methodologies (Agile, Lean Startup, Design Thinking).
- Community Integration: Join forums, groups, and events for peer collaboration.
- First-week checklist: Equipment received, HR forms completed, tasks assigned, reporting schedule agreed; diagnostic skills assessment initiated.
- Data Consent Form signature

12. Roles, Responsibilities & Expected Conduct

Interns: Complete tasks, submit weekly reports, maintain professionalism, respect confidentiality and safety rules; participate in peer-to-peer learning. Supervisors: Assign tasks, provide guidance, track KPIs, complete evaluations. Mentors: Provide career guidance, monthly check-ins, and coaching aligned with Pathway support. HR / Program Lead: Manage recruitment, onboarding, compliance, and grievance handling.

13. Work Plan & Sample Weekly Schedule

Innovation Track (12 weeks, aligned with Pathway stages):

Week	Activities	Deliverables
1	Onboarding, project brief, skills assessment	Project charter, personalized learning path
2–4	Research & design, core training modules	Research brief, Lean Canvas
5–7	Prototype build, market validation	Working prototype, customer feedback report



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8–10	User testing & iteration, mentorship sessions	Test report
11	Final outputs, investor readiness	Documentation & prototype
12	Presentation & reflection	Slide deck, report, blog posts, certificates

Hub Operations Track (8 weeks, incorporating capability building):

Week	Activities	Deliverables
1	Onboarding & shadowing, diagnostic assessment	Checklist, personalized path
2–3	Communications & events, training modules	Event brief / posts
4–6	Execution & improvements, peer learning	Completed event/report
7	Evaluation, milestone reviews	Interim report
8	Wrap-up	Final report, blog posts, certifications

14. Productivity Metrics (KPIs)

KPI	Measurement	Target
Task completion	% tasks finished	≥90%
Quality of work	Supervisor rating 1–5	≥3.5
Attendance	Attendance score	≥95%
Weekly reports	Submission on time	100%
Collaboration	Peer/supervisor feedback	≥3.5
Learning goals	% achieved (via analytics)	≥70%
Blogs & certifications	Submission & quality	100% & approved
Milestone achievement	Progress against Pathway goals	≥80%

Blogs and certifications are formal KPIs and part of the final assessment.

15. Reporting Requirements



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- Weekly: Tasks completed, progress, blockers, learnings, next week plan; logged in digital dashboard.
- Midterm: Progress vs objectives, achievements, challenges, updated learning plan; continuous feedback incorporated.
- Final: Objectives vs outcomes, deliverables, impact, lessons learned, blogs, certifications, portfolio links; impact tracking (e.g., contributions to SDGs).

16. Supervision, Mentorship, Professional Development & Log Book Submission Requirements

- Weekly one-on-one check-ins with supervisors.
- Mentor sessions: Monthly 1:1, mid-program & final reflection; matched based on skills gaps.
- Minimum one professional development session per month, including core modules (business, technical, market skills) and supplemental resources (webinars, case studies).
- Practical assignments tied to startup deliverables.

All interns are required to submit log books weekly for assessment without fail, ensuring consistent documentation of progress and alignment with the JHUB Africa Innovation Pathway's emphasis on milestone tracking and feedback.

- **Purpose:** Log books provide a detailed record of daily activities, progress toward project milestones, challenges faced, and learnings gained, enabling supervisors to monitor performance, provide targeted feedback, and ensure alignment with internship objectives.
- **Content:** Each log book entry must include:
 - o Date and hours worked
 - o Tasks completed and their relevance to project deliverables
 - o Challenges encountered and solutions attempted
 - o Key learnings and skills applied or developed
 - o Progress toward Pathway milestones (e.g., prototype development, market validation)
- **Submission Process:**
 - o Log books are submitted via the JHUB office by 5:00 PM every Friday.



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- o Supervisors review log books within three working days, providing feedback via the portal to support skill development and project alignment.
- **Evaluation:**
 - o Timely submission is a mandatory KPI, weighted in the final assessment (see Section 14).
 - o Quality of entries is assessed based on completeness, clarity, and relevance to project goals, contributing to the "Blogs, Certifications & Log Books" evaluation category.
 - o Non-submission or late submission without prior approval (e.g., due to extenuating circumstances communicated to the supervisor) results in a deduction from the attendance KPI.

17. Performance Evaluation

Midterm: 1–5 scale across Task Completion, Quality, Teamwork, Initiative, Communication, Professionalism. Final: Weighted scoring: Task Completion 30%, Quality 20%, Teamwork 15%, Initiative 10%, Learning 10%, Blogs & Certifications 15%. Grades: Excellent $\geq 85\%$, Satisfactory 70–84%, Needs Improvement 50–69%, Unsatisfactory $< 50\%$. Incorporates performance analytics and feedback loops.

18. Deliverables & Exit Requirements

- Final report & slide deck.
- Code, documentation, assets in repository.
- Blogs summarizing learning and contributions.
- Certifications from training/workshops undertaken.
- Self-evaluation form.
- Supervisor evaluation.
- Exit presentation, including demo if applicable.

Blogs and certifications are evaluated as part of the final assessment.

19. Intellectual Property, Data Protection & Publication Policy

- Intern work produced during placement is owned/licensed to JHUB Africa/JKUAT; sign IP policy and collaboration agreement pre-day 1.



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- IP disclosure form required; protection support (copyrights, patents, trademarks) available via Pathway resources.
- Data anonymisation and approved storage required.
- Publications credit follows academic conventions and Hub policies.

20. Benefits, Equipment & Logistics

- Stipends are not offered; this is an unpaid internship.
- Benefits: Access to facilities, events, workshops, mentorship, certification; alumni network access post-internship.
- Equipment: GPU's, desktops access at the labs, software access, cloud credits; return required at end of internship.
- Expense reimbursement policy: Interns cover their own expenses unless pre-approved.

21. Code of Conduct & Disciplinary Procedures

- Professional, respectful, and transparent behavior expected.
- Confidentiality mandatory.
- Disciplinary steps: Verbal warning → written warning → probation → termination.

22. Termination, Extension & Grievance Procedures

- Termination: 2-week notice or immediate for gross misconduct.
- Extension: Agreed in writing, new Placement Details form required; possible for high performers.
- Grievance: Submit to HR/Programs; resolution within 10 working days.

23. Certification, References & Post-Internship Pathways

- Certificates issued for satisfactory completion (this applies to Hub Operations Track)
- Supervisor reference letters (Recommendation) for high performers.
- Join alumni network for ongoing networking, funding access, mentorship roles, and continuous learning (e.g., advanced modules, global opportunities).
- Impact tracking: Monitor post-internship contributions (e.g., jobs created, SDG alignment).



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24. Governance & Contact Information

- Founder, JHUB Africa, Hub Manager, HR, Lab Safety Officer contacts listed.
- Intern records maintained for 3 years.

25. Appendices (Templates & Forms)

- A. Weekly Progress Report
- B. Midterm & Final Evaluation Form
- C. Final Presentation & Blog Submission Outline
- D. Acceptance / Appointment Letter
- E. Confidentiality & IP Agreement (updated with Pathway elements)
- F. Onboarding Checklist (including skills assessment)
- G. Intern Pledge / Signature Page
- H. Personalized Learning Path Template (new, from Pathway)



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